

Taser Shotguns at CES

The bright yellow X12 shotgun, has a range of 82 feet and fires self powered electrical bullets

Induction power

A company used induction power to create innovative packaging for cereal boxes that lights up in stages

all of the hardware devices and peripherals." The announcement was accompanied by technical demonstrations by Microsoft executives Steven Sinofsky (President, Windows and Windows Live Division) and Mike Angiulo (Corporate Vice President, Windows Planning, Hardware and PC Ecosystem) of a hybrid version of Windows (retaining Win 7's interface, but showing wide support for both ARM and x86 based SoC architectures) across various platforms. The demonstrations showed off the capability of Windows, even in this raw form, to provide features such as hardware-accelerated graphics and media playback, hardware-accelerated Web browsing (on Internet Explorer 9), USB device support, and printing across platforms.

Microsoft is working with all the relevant "silicon partners", from ARM to Intel to Qualcomm and Texas Instruments, to make this platform agnostic and/or versions-for-everyone future possible.

Motion controllers specially for the PC

First there was Wii, then came PS Move and Kinect. More than revolutionising how people play games (using gestures), these technologies have just given console fanboys another point to strengthen their case. Since then PC users have been wondering when they will get to stand in front of their LCDs and jump up and down like monkeys.

Just at a time when we were planning to have a build-your-own-webcam-Kinect, comes news from CES that the same guys who brought us the technology behind Kinect (PrimeSense) are now teaming up

with none other than ASUS to create a controller-free experience for Windows-based PCs.

The platform christened Xtion Pro, will be showcased this week at CES 2011 in Las Vegas. The ASUS WAVI Xtion device will use ultra-wide band wireless link and PrimeSense 3D sensing solution to bring controller free interaction to the PC and hey, why not motion based gaming too? It may have other applications too. As a media centre device it's not hard to imagine using a flick of the hand to change a channel instead of fiddling around with wire-less keyboards or mice.

To support the ecosystem, ASUS is also planning to open

features at the Photofair 2011; such as the HS system (Hyper-sensitivity sensor) and the Digic 4 image processor for that super-fine image clarity & low sensor noise. Let's take a sneak peek at some of the interesting compact digital cameras that were unveiled on this occasion.

Canon's CES 2011 PowerShot quartet includes: A800, A1200,

The PowerShot A1200 inherits the hardware specifications from its elder sibling the A2200, with the exception of dropping the sensor to 12.1 megapixel and removing the discrete mode that acts as a silencer to shoot more quietly. It also includes a tiny optical view finder for the geeks. Moving up the hierarchy, the



Canon Vixia HF G10



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up the 3D Sensing Development platform to allow developers to create their own gesture-based apps and software.

Canon's revelations

Canon's CES 2011 seems to be in sync with the Photofair 2011, contributing to the grand pre-release announcement of PowerShot octet in unison. While the CES 2011 saw some surprises up its sleeve, the Photofair 2011 (ongoing at Pragati Maidan, Delhi) does not seem far behind in this mad race for the market share. Canon has made it doubly sure, by offering some innovative and technologically advanced

A2200 and A3300 IS. Venturing into the sub \$100 domain, the A800 makes an impact with the 10 megapixel sensor, VGA video with blur reduction, and a 2.5-inch LCD. We could not have asked for a better bargain at a selling price of \$89.



Canon-powershot-a3300

\$139 A2200 dazzles with the creative filters, 720p HD video, and discrete mode along with a 14 megapixel sensor, 4x optical zoom, and a 2.7-inch LCD. Finally, the big brother - \$179 A3300 IS outsmarts its siblings with a 16 megapixel sensor, 720p HD video, 5x optical zoom, a 3-inch LCD, an array of creative filters including "toy camera" & monochrome, and the discrete mode.

Well, if you were wondering about the odd Mr. X, we are talking about the muscular flagship flagships camcorder - the VIXIA HF G10 making headlines with the HD CMOS sensor and manual focus. Its key specifications include: approximately 2 Megapixel (i.e. 1920 x 1080

resolution) HD CMOS sensor, a 10x optical zoom, manual focus ring, 3.5-inch touch-screen LCD, 32GB internal memory, dual SDXC slots, cinema filters. It is expected to hit the stands at a steep price of \$1499 in March 2011. 